

Called Cyanogen Modular OS, the initiative is aimed to do more with Android by offering smartphone manufacturers a way to easily customise their smartphones using different parts of the original Cyanogen OS. The company is set to provide dynamic modules and MODs that can work on top of any Android environment, such as stock Android or a custom ROM.



“Cyanogen’s Modular OS programme will allow value, independence and intelligence to flow freely between the layers of the ecosystem, providing more companies and developers with the freedom to borrow from, unite and utilise our technology in new and innovative ways,” wrote Tal, in a blog post.

In addition to its way of reaching out to various manufacturers, Cyanogen is broadening its ecosystem through the modular programme as it will host multiple products in areas including artificial intelligence (AI) cloud services. The California based company is also planning to enable developers to customise modules.

It is worth noting here that millions of enthusiasts have already contributed towards CyanogenMod, a custom Android ROM developed by Cyanogen. These participants are likely to make a shift to the company’s modules and MODs.

Although Tal’s post has not revealed any particular reason for the change, it highlights some challenges in the smartphone market. “Android has become extremely fragmented, causing serious security vulnerabilities and there are few or no incentives for device manufacturers to deliver software upgrades and/or security patches,” he stated.

The development of modules does not mean that Cyanogen OS is leaving the operating system world. The custom ROM, which offers improvements over vanilla Android, will continue to be available. Further, nearly 20 devices that are officially running a CyanogenMod version would get future updates from the community.

## Ubuntu 16.10 brings ‘true’ hybrid cloud operations

Canonical has just announced the much-anticipated public release of Ubuntu 16.10. Codenamed Yakkety Yak, the new open source platform is aimed at expanding cloud deployments.

Ubuntu 16.10 comes preloaded with Juju 2.0 to enable organisational operations with ‘big software’ applications

such as Hadoop and Kubernetes across public cloud and private infrastructure. There is also support for VSphere infrastructure to let enterprises deploy private cloud solutions on OpenStack as well as VMware.

Apart from the advanced Juju tool version, Canonical has added MAAS 2.0 to offer bare metal provisioning alongside the fresh Ubuntu experience. The operating system additionally comes with the LXD pure-container hypervisor to deliver high-level management and performance for various container solutions.

“The world’s fastest hypervisor, LXD, and the world’s best cloud operating system, Ubuntu, together with the latest OpenStack and Kubernetes make for the world’s fastest and best private cloud infrastructure,” said Mark Shuttleworth, founder of the Ubuntu project at Canonical, in a statement.

Shuttleworth added that the prime focus of releasing the new Ubuntu version is to enable ‘true’ hybrid cloud operations. “This release further enhances the tools and platform that most companies depend on to operate effectively across all major public clouds and in one’s own data centre, from bare metal to cloud container,” he concluded.

Continuing the trend of pushing snaps over debs, Ubuntu 16.10 natively supports snap Linux packages. However, unlike its previous versions, the newest Ubuntu platform enables snap packages with container and packaging technology. This provides developers a unified format to distribute apps and services for computing devices, the cloud and IoT.



Also, Canonical’s Ubuntu now includes updated versions of the Data Plane Development Kit (DPDK), OpenVSwitch (OVS) and various virtualisation technologies to handle critical application traffic for lower latency and greater throughput.

In addition to the features for cloud deployments, Ubuntu 16.10 has the Unity 8 developer preview. This latest version of the device convergence vision sets the stage for future Linux devices by enabling apps that can scale from the phone to the desktop and shift from the mouse to the touchscreen.

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